

## THE LAST FIVE YEARS · THE SECOND SCREEN

## The Cue Bible

build-2026-08-27P · how phones work

187 cues · 14 songs · generated from the live show build, so this document cannot drift from what the phones actually do

**THE STANDING RULE (new in 27L): the phone behaves exactly like a real phone.** Tapping a notification IS the unlock — the app opens directly, no home screen. Inboxes and message lists load whole the instant the app opens, and a full life continues past the bottom edge of the glass. Only what would genuinely arrive right now — a text, a notification, new mail — appears live, and new mail lands at the top. Anything that violates this is a bug, even if it would make a nice theatrical beat.

How to read each entry: the header gives the cue ID, which screen, whose phone, the app, and the musical anchor. ON SCREEN is the complete content, verbatim and untruncated. PLAYS covers mechanics the engine performs on its own — navigation, self-timed animation, synthesized sound. PHONES gives the state after the cue when it changed. Gold notes carry dramaturgy, holds, and open director choices.

## 1 · Still Hurting CATHY SINGS · 20 FIRES

COLD OPEN. Her phone is the first actor on stage. The house learns the grammar wordlessly: a notification is tapped and the app is simply there; a list is already full; only what would truly arrive live ever arrives live.

### 1.1 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — First piano bar — house settles

Her phone, lit and locked, already in her hand. JUNE 2026.

#### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “JUNE 2026”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 9:41 · Friday, June 12, 2026

**WALLPAPER** — cast photo of JAMIE — she never changed it

#### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

**PHONES** SR = Lock screen · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:41

### 1.2 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — Intro, phrase 2

FACEBOOK pushes a Memories notification. The algorithm has no idea.

#### ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION — Facebook · Memories (now):** “You have memories with Jamie Wellerstein to look back on today”

#### PLAYS

sound: receive ding

#### SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

### 1.3 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — Intro, phrase 3 — she gives in

She taps the notification. Face ID, and Facebook opens straight onto ON THIS DAY — one motion, no home screen.

#### PLAYS

**TAP THE NOTIFICATION** — the touch-dot lands on the banner, presses, Face ID passes, and the app opens **DIRECTLY** onto Facebook Memories. One motion. No home screen.

#### SOUND

tap thock

**PHONES** SR = Facebook Memories · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:41

**HOLD** · A beat on the notification before she commits.

**1.4 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories** — *CATHERINE is discovered. SHE wears a wedding ring.*

2021 — five years ago today. The first summer.

**ON SCREEN**

**MEMORY CARD** — 5 years ago · 2021 — Cathy Hiatt · June 12, 2021

**post:** "is it insane to be this happy after nine months"

**media:** M18 — first-date night walk

**reactions:** 👍 64

**PLAYS**

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

**1.5 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories** — *Jamie is over and Jamie is gone.*

2022 — the year of the couch and the second Christmas.

**ON SCREEN**

**MEMORY CARD** — 4 years ago · 2022 — Cathy Hiatt · June 12, 2022

**post:** "our apartment has a name now. it is called The Couch."

**media:** M15 — the hideous couch

**reactions:** 👍 88

**PLAYS**

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

**1.6 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories** — *Jamie's decided it's time to move on.*

2023 — the proposal. Her scroll stalls halfway with the card half-revealed — a beat of not being ready — then commits.

**ON SCREEN**

**MEMORY CARD** — 3 years ago · 2023 — Cathy Hiatt · June 12, 2023

**post:** "he asked. I said yes before he finished 💍"

**media:** M3a — the ring, the rowboat

**reactions:** 👍 341

**PLAYS**

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

**1.7 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories** — *Jamie has new dreams he's building upon,*

2024 — the wedding portrait. Dragged into view slowly, thumb never leaving the glass.

**ON SCREEN**

**MEMORY CARD** — 2 years ago · 2024 — Cathy Hiatt-Wellerstein · June 12, 2024

**post:** "married three weeks and 800 miles apart. worth it."

**media:** M4 — the wedding portrait

**reactions:** 👍 402

**PLAYS**

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

**1.8 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories** — *And I'm still hurting.*

2025 — the pier. Her first flick fails and the feed snaps back — she is not ready for this one — a long beat, then she drags it over herself.

**ON SCREEN**

**MEMORY CARD** — 1 year ago · 2025 — Cathy Hiatt-Wellerstein · June 12, 2025

**post:** "look who made it to Ohio 🥰"

**media:** M1 — the pier, golden hour

**reactions:** 👍 47

**PLAYS**

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

**HOLD** · *Five years in five cards. Let this one sit before she looks away.*

**1.9 SR · CATHY · Messages** — *Jamie arrived at the end of the line.*

She leaves Facebook. Messages. Everyone knows — the whole list is condolences.

**ON SCREEN**

**MESSAGES LIST** — loads whole, already full:

- Jamie — "You: please just call me" (Wednesday)
- Mom ❤️ • — "call me when you're up. I love you." (8:02 AM)
- Dana + girls 🍷 • — "Dana: we're coming over at 7. non-negotiable." (7:41 AM)

- Grammy • — “bubbeleh. are you eating?” (Yesterday)
- Beth — “just heard. I’m so so sorry ❤️” (Yesterday)
- Aunt Patti — “your mother told me. calling tonight” (Wednesday)
- Michael (voice) — “no lesson this week. take care of you.” (Tuesday)
- Ohio Housing — “Re: summer sublet — deposit received” (Monday)
- CVS Pharmacy — “Your prescription is ready for pickup” (Monday)
- Dentist — Dr. Okafor — “Reminder: cleaning Jun 22, 2:30 PM” (Sunday)

**PLAYS**

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap  
no animation — the list is already full; the last rows cut off at the bottom of the glass

PHONES SR = Messages · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:41

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**1.10** SR · CATHY · Messages — *Jamie’s convinced that the problems are mine.*

HOLD — the touch hovers over his name and does not commit.

**PLAYS**

HESITATION — the pulsing touch-dot hovers over “Jamie” ... and does not commit. Holds until the next cue.

**HOLD** · *FERMATA. No fixed length. This is the hesitation the whole opening is built on.*

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**1.11** SR · CATHY · Messages — *Jamie is probably feeling just fine,*

Tap. The thread opens mid-history — cold logistics from May going colder, then days of her asking, all Delivered, all silent.

**ON SCREEN**

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

- May 12 · 6:40 PM
- SENT (blue):** “your mail is piling up here”
- RECEIVED (gray):** “I’ll come by this week”
- SENT (blue):** “ok”
- May 30 · 9:12 PM
- SENT (blue):** “the super needs to know about the lease by the 15th”
- Monday · 11:02 PM
- SENT (blue):** “are you coming home this weekend?”
- Wednesday · 8:15 AM
- SENT (blue):** “please just call me”
- Wednesday · 9:30 PM
- SENT (blue):** “I still have your ring”
- status:** Delivered

**PLAYS**

TAP COMMITS — the dot presses through and vanishes · sound: tap  
thread pushes in from the list — Jamie

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**1.12** SR · CATHY · Messages — *And I’m still hurting.*

PRESENT — 9:41 this morning. She types it live.

**ON SCREEN**

**thread caption:** Today · 9:41 AM  
**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “I’m not sure that I can do this without you”

**PLAYS**

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

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**1.13** SR · CATHY · Messages — *What about lies, Jamie?*

SHE SENDS IT. Delivered.

**ON SCREEN**

**SEND** — the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble  
**delivery status:** Delivered

**PLAYS**

sound: send swoosh

## SOUND

send whoosh

**1.14** SR · CATHY · Messages — *What about things that you swore to be true?*

Delivered → READ. He is awake. He is holding his phone.

## ON SCREEN

**STATUS FLIPS** → Read 9:42 AM**HOLD** · *Let the receipt sit alone for a full phrase.***1.15** SR · CATHY · Messages — *What about you, Jamie?*

His typing bubble rises. He is answering.

## ON SCREEN

**typing indicator rises (three dots)****1.16** SR · CATHY · Messages — *What about you?*

It stops. Nothing comes. He read it and put the phone down.

## ON SCREEN

**typing indicator disappears****HOLD** · *The cruellest silence available in 2026.***1.17** SR · CATHY · Mail — *Jamie is sure something wonderful died.*

She opens Mail. His name sits in the middle of a life that kept sending promotions — read Wednesday, and she has been living with it since. He did not text. He EMAILED.

## ON SCREEN

**INBOX — loads whole, the instant the app opens:**

- Playbill — This week on Broadway — Six closings, two announcements, and... (6:12 AM)
- Jamie Wellerstein — Some practical things — Cathy — I didn't want to do this over the phone. I went... (Wed)
- Chase — Account closed — joint checking — Confirmation of closure. Funds transferred. (Wed)
- U-MOVE — Booking confirmed — Saturday 8:00 AM — 1 bedroom · pickup W 73rd St (Wed)
- Kessler & Roth LLP — Following our call — Attached, as discussed. Please review at your convenience. (Wed)
- Backstage — 12 new roles match your profile — Soprano, 20s-30s — apply today (Tuesday)
- Mom — Fwd: FWD: RE: the recipe (the good one) — honey you asked for this at christmas (Tuesday)
- ClassPass — We miss you! Here's 20% back — Your credits expire soon (Monday)
- Actors' Equity — June member newsletter — Contract updates, open calls, and... (Monday)
- Spectrum — Your bill is ready — AutoPay scheduled for Jun 15 (Sunday)

## PLAYS

OPENS Mail — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

no animation — a real inbox does not populate; it is simply THERE, continuing past the bottom edge

**PHONES** SR = Mail · stamp "JUNE 2026" · clock 9:41**1.18** SR · CATHY · Mail — reading — *Jamie decides it's his right to decide.*

She opens his email. The break-up, formatted like a memo — he has already done everything.

## ON SCREEN

**THE EMAIL, OPENED** — Jamie Wellerstein → Cathy · "Some practical things" · Wed 4:12 PM  
Cathy —

I didn't want to do this over the phone.

I went downtown this morning and closed the joint account. Your half is in your checking.

The movers come Saturday at 8 for my things. You don't have to be there.

I'll leave my keys on the counter.

I think we've both known for a while.

— J

## PLAYS

HESITATION — the pulsing touch-dot hovers over "Jamie Wellerstein" ... and does not commit. Holds until the next cue.

the dot presses through — the email pushes in over the inbox

**PHONES** SR = Mail – reading · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:41

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**1.19** SR · CATHY · Mail — *Jamie’s got secrets he can’t confide,*

Back to the list — and the lawyer’s email sits stamped 2:50 PM, before the one he sent her. He told the lawyer first.

**PLAYS**

cut to Mail (instant)

HESITATION — the pulsing touch-dot hovers over “Kessler & Roth LLP” ... and does not commit. Holds until the next cue.

**PHONES** SR = Mail · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:41

**HOLD** · *The dot hovers over Kessler & Roth... and she cannot open it. Land it alone.*

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**1.20** SR · CATHY — *And I’m still hurting. (final)*

HARD BLACK on the cutoff.

**ON SCREEN**

**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it

**PLAYS**

hard black

**SOUND**

room tone out

## 2 · Shiksa Goddess JAMIE SINGS · 10 FIRES

THE SAME DEVICE, INVERTED. His opening mirrors hers gesture for gesture — except he never hesitates. Charming speed now; indictment by the end of the night.

### 2.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *Segue chord out of her blackout*

His phone, September 2021, 11:38 PM. Locked. Walking home.

ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “SEPTEMBER 2021”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:38 · Friday, September 3, 2021

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 11:38

### 2.2 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *I’m breaking my mother’s heart,*

Unlock, straight to Messages — no hesitation; her opening took four cues, his takes two. Her number sits on top, one hour old. Beneath it: the trail of nice Jewish girls he is about to escape.

ON SCREEN

**MESSAGES LIST** — loads whole, already full:

- Cathy Hiatt ● — “it’s cathy 😊 — from tonight” (10:42 PM)
- Rob ● — “well??? how’d it go” (11:12 PM)
- Mom ❤️ ● — “dinner sunday. no excuses.” (8:05 PM)
- Linda Whitfield — “pages by Friday. I mean it.” (Yesterday)
- Elissa Weiss — “You: it was fun, but...” (Tuesday)
- H. Greenblatt — “ok. good luck with the book I guess” (Monday)
- S. Rosen — “You: I’ll call you this week” (2 wks ago)
- Columbia workshop — “Adam: notes attached for Thursday” (2 wks ago)

PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

no animation — the list is already full; the last rows cut off at the bottom of the glass

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 11:38

### 2.3 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *The JCC of Spring Valley is shaking,*

He taps her row instantly. A thread one hour old — one message in it: her number.

ON SCREEN

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

— Today · 10:42 PM

**RECEIVED (gray):** “it’s cathy 😊 — from tonight”

PLAYS

HESITATION — the pulsing touch-dot hovers over “Cathy Hiatt” ... and does not commit. Holds until the next cue.

TAP COMMITS — the dot presses through and vanishes · sound: tap  
thread pushes in from the list — Cathy Hiatt

### 2.4 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *And if you had a tattoo, that wouldn’t matter.*

PRESENT, 11:39 — a long overwrought draft, typed in full.

ON SCREEN

**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:39

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “Tonight was maybe the best night of my whole life”

PLAYS

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

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**2.5** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *And if you had a shaved head, that would be cool.*

Backspaces every character. Clock ticks to 11:41.

ON SCREEN

**BACKSPACES** the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

**LOCK CLOCK** – 11:41

PLAYS

sound: backspace rattle

SOUND

rapid delete clicks

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**2.6** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *If you came from Spain or Japan or the back of a van—*

A second, bolder draft.

ON SCREEN

**TYPES LIVE** (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “So when can I see you again. Tomorrow?”

PLAYS

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

---

**2.7** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *Just as long as you’re not from Hebrew school.*

Deletes that one too. 11:45. Ten minutes on a sidewalk, failing to write a text.

ON SCREEN

**BACKSPACES** the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

**LOCK CLOCK** – 11:45

PLAYS

sound: backspace rattle

SOUND

rapid delete clicks

---

**2.8** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *I’ve been waiting for someone like you.*

Types two casual words instead.

ON SCREEN

**LOCK CLOCK** – 11:48

**thread caption:** · 11:48 PM

**TYPES LIVE** (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “home safe?”

PLAYS

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

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**2.9** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *I’ve been waiting for you.*

SEND. The whole song, reduced to two words.

ON SCREEN

**SEND** – the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

**delivery status:** Delivered

PLAYS

sound: send swoosh

SOUND

send whoosh

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**2.10** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *Vamp under the button*

Her typing bubble appears — and stays up. The finale pays this off at 11:58.

ON SCREEN

**typing indicator rises** (three dots)

## 3 · See I'm Smiling CATHY SINGS · 15 FIRES

THE BIRTHDAY PERFORMANCE. Public joy on the feed, private evidence in the mail. The stamps spin backward for the embedded calls — the house learns the projections can time-travel.

### 3.1 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — *Scene change into Ohio*

Her phone. OHIO, July 2025 — her birthday at the summer theatre, and he came.

ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → "JULY 2025 · OHIO · HER BIRTHDAY"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 6:12 · Saturday, July 19, 2025

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY's screen

PHONES SR = Lock screen · stamp "JULY 2025 · OHIO · HER BIRTHDAY" · clock 6:12

### 3.2 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *Jamie, I'm so happy you're here!*

She posts the pier photo.

ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST** — **Cathy Hiatt-Wellerstein (now)**: "look who made it to Ohio 🥳 best birthday present"

**media**: M1 — cast photo: the pier, golden hour

**reactions**: 👍 47

PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SR = Facebook · stamp "JULY 2025 · OHIO · HER BIRTHDAY" · clock 6:12

### 3.3 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *I could sing, I could scream!*

Likes climb.

ON SCREEN

**LIKE COUNTER SPINS** → 47

### 3.4 SR · CATHY · Mail — *HER face falls — JAMIE tells her he is leaving tomorrow.*

Still in Facebook when the banner drops over the likes: Fwd from Jamie. She leaves Facebook, opens Mail — his forward sits on top, unread.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION** — **Mail · Jamie (now)**: "Fwd: Your eTicket — TOMORROW 7:15 PM"

**INBOX** — loads whole, the instant the app opens:

· Jamie ● — Fwd: Your eTicket — TOMORROW 7:15 PM — Amtrak: CLE → NYP · 1 passenger · J. Wellerstein (now)

· Summer Season (Ohio) — Week 6 — rehearsal schedule — Company call 10 AM · fittings after... (Yesterday)

· Mom — Fwd: BIRTHDAY GIRL!! — grandma's card is in the mail honey (Yesterday)

· Backstage — Fall season — open calls posted — 14 new roles match your profile (Thursday)

· Medina Coffee Co. — Your punch card is full ☕ — A free drink is waiting (Wednesday)

· Actors' Equity — July member newsletter — Contract updates, open calls, and... (Tuesday)

· Venmo — Dana paid you \$14 — "bday wine 🍷" — Payment received (Monday)

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

OPENS Mail — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

no animation — a real inbox does not populate; it is simply THERE, continuing past the bottom edge

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

PHONES SR = Mail · stamp "JULY 2025 · OHIO · HER BIRTHDAY" · clock 6:12



**HOLD** · *She finds out the way anyone finds out: a forwarded receipt over something happy. Fire on the blocking, not the score.*

### 3.5 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — *Underscore turns into the flashback*

The stamp spins five years back. Her phone the whole way.

ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → "FIVE YEARS EARLIER"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 2:41 · Tuesday, September 14, 2021

PLAYS

cut to Lock screen (instant)

PHONES SR = Lock screen · stamp "FIVE YEARS EARLIER" · clock 2:41

### 3.6 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — *One bar later*

September 2021. She is waiting to hear from him.

ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → "SEPTEMBER 2021"

PHONES SR = Lock screen · stamp "SEPTEMBER 2021" · clock 2:41

### 3.7 SR · CATHY · Phone — *JAMIE, on the phone with his agent*

Her phone rings. It is him, calling with the news.

ON SCREEN

**CALL SCREEN** — Jamie ✨ · incoming call · incoming

SOUND

outgoing ring

PHONES SR = Phone · stamp "SEPTEMBER 2021" · clock 2:41

### 3.8 SR · CATHY · Phone — *They want the book.*

She answers. Two minutes of the best news of his life.

ON SCREEN

**call state** → connected · 02:13

### 3.9 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — *Lights restore on her — Ohio, July 2025*

Back to the present. Her lock screen, 11:58 PM.

ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → "JULY 2025 · OHIO"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:58 · Saturday, July 19, 2025

PLAYS

cut to Lock screen (instant)

PHONES SR = Lock screen · stamp "JULY 2025 · OHIO" · clock 11:58

### 3.10 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — *See, I'm smiling —*

The birthday drawer fills. Mom first.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION** — Messages · Mom (8:12 AM): "HAPPY BIRTHDAY SWEET GIRL 🎂"

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

### 3.11 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — *That's what I do —*

Richard, from the show.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION** — Messages · Richard (company) (9:40 AM): "birthday drinks after the show?"

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

**3.12** SR · CATHY · Lock screen — *When you come home to me.*

Grammy's voicemail already knows.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION — Phone · Grammy · Voicemail (4:03 PM):** "...he WHAT. on your BIRTHDAY. bubbeleh—"

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

**3.13** SR · CATHY · Lock screen — *(after his exit)*

11:58 PM. Him. Lowercase. Six words.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION — Messages · Jamie (11:58 PM):** "happy bday. good show tonight."

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

**HOLD** · *Let the drawer sit before this lands.*

**3.14** SR · CATHY · Messages — *Final held note*

She taps his notification. The thread opens on today — the visit that started hopeful this morning, and his six cold words at the end of it. She types the whole rant live.

ON SCREEN

**THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:**

— Today · 9:12 AM

**RECEIVED (gray):** "landed. getting the rental"

**SENT (blue):** "pier at 4? bring a jacket"

**RECEIVED (gray):** "wouldn't miss it"

— Today · 11:58 PM

**RECEIVED (gray):** "happy bday. good show tonight."

**thread caption:** Today · 11:59 PM

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** "you cannot spend one single day that is not about you"

PLAYS

TAP THE NOTIFICATION — the touch-dot lands on the banner, presses, Face ID passes, and the app opens DIRECTLY onto Messages. One motion. No home screen.

sound: key clicks

SOUND

tap thock

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

PHONES SR = Messages · stamp "JULY 2025 · OHIO" · clock 11:58

**3.15** SR · CATHY — *Cutoff*

Deletes it. Black.

ON SCREEN

**BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)**

**caption:** DRAFT · DELETED

**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

sound: backspace rattle

hard black

SOUND

rapid delete clicks

room tone out

## 4 · Moving Too Fast JAMIE SINGS · 18 FIRES

THE AVALANCHE. His lock screen outruns the audience's ability to read it, which is the point. The happy infrastructure of the marriage is installed here, item by item, so the back half can dismantle it.

### 4.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *Count-off — drums in*

His phone, October 2021. Locked, about to detonate.

ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → "OCTOBER 2021"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 2:14 · Friday, October 8, 2021

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE's screen

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp "OCTOBER 2021" · clock 2:14

### 4.2 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *I'm up in the morning,*

They want the book.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION — Messages · Linda Whitfield (now):** "They want the book. Call me. — L"

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

### 4.3 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *I'm taking a shower,*

The Atlantic says yes.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION — Mail · The Atlantic Monthly (2m):** "We are delighted to publish your excerpt"

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

### 4.4 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *I'm out on the street,*

He drops out of Columbia.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION — Mail · Columbia University (1h):** "Withdrawal processed — Fall term ✓"

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

### 4.5 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *And I'm dressed and I'm ready,*

Two thousand dollars.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION — Chase (now):** "You received a deposit of \$2,000.00"

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

### 4.6 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *And I'm taking the stairs,*

JOINT ACCOUNT OPENED. The finale closes this exact account.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION — Chase (now):** "New account opened — Joint Checking ••4417"

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

**HOLD · Plant it clearly. It pays off two hours from now.**

**4.7 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *Something's happening!***

THE BIGGEST HIT. Sonny read it.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION — Messages · Linda Whitfield (now):** "SONNY READ IT. CALL ME NOW."

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

**4.8 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *I'm feeling alive!***

NPR wants him.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION — Mail · NPR (now):** "Interview request — new voices in fiction"

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

**4.9 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *And the sky is bright —***

"do NOT answer NPR until we talk." Let the laugh land.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION — Messages · Linda Whitfield (now):** "do NOT answer NPR until we talk"

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

**4.10 SL · JAMIE · calevent — *And I'm sure my career will explode,***

Move-in day goes on the calendar — the real event, on the real app.

ON SCREEN

**CALENDAR EVENT — "MOVE-IN DAY 📅 — W 73rd St" · Saturday, Oct 16 · 9:00 AM · W 73rd St & Columbus**

**invitees:** Jamie Wellerstein ✓ · Cathy Hiatt ✓

PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Calendar — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SL = calevent · stamp "OCTOBER 2021" · clock 2:14

**4.11 SL · JAMIE · calevent — *And I'll never lose my hair,***

The signed lease lands as a banner over the calendar — both names on it.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION — Mail · Dropbox Sign (now):** "Completed: Lease — W 73rd St · Signed by J. Wellerstein and C. Hiatt ✓"

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

**4.12 SL · JAMIE · findmy — *And I'll never see thirty,***

Find My — her pin and his on the same map, sharing Until: Forever both ways. Nobody Needs to Know ends it.

ON SCREEN

**FIND MY — People:** Cathy Hiatt: Columbus Ave · now — sharing Until: Forever · Mom ❤️: Spring Valley · 2 hr ago

PLAYS

OPENS FindMy — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = findmy · stamp "OCTOBER 2021" · clock 2:14

#### 4.13 SL · JAMIE · settings2 — *I'm so happy I won't last a day!*

THE RULE THEY MAKE TOGETHER — a real Focus schedule, 10 PM to 6 AM. Elise gets an exception to this in A Miracle Would Happen.

ON SCREEN

**SETTINGS** — Focus > Do Not Disturb

- Do Not Disturb — ON
- 10:00 PM — 6:00 AM — ON (Repeats daily)
- Share Across Devices — ON

**footer:** Schedule note: "so we actually sleep" — created together

PLAYS

OPENS Settings — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = settings2 · stamp "OCTOBER 2021" · clock 2:14

**HOLD** · *The most important quiet plant in the show.*

#### 4.14 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *(the couch vignette)*

Her thread — six weeks deep already, overflowing above — and a real Marketplace link card lands: the hideous couch, \$75.

ON SCREEN

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

— Sunday · 1:15 PM

**RECEIVED (gray):** "my mom asked about you AGAIN"

**SENT (blue):** "tell her I said hi"

**RECEIVED (gray):** "absolutely not. she'll take it as a proposal"

— Yesterday · 8:44 PM

**SENT (blue):** "keys friday!! bring the tape measure"

**RECEIVED (gray):** "I'm bringing champagne and ONE fork"

— Today · 6:30 PM

**RECEIVED (gray) — LINK CARD:** Mid-Century Sofa — \$75 · Upper West Side · facebook.com · image: M15 — the hideous couch, listing photo

**RECEIVED (gray):** "it's hideous. I love it."

PLAYS

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp "OCTOBER 2021" · clock 2:14

**HOLD** · *Let the listing card land and be read in the house before 4.15 fires.*

#### 4.15 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *(vamp)*

He buys it before she finishes the sentence.

ON SCREEN

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** "buying it right now"

PLAYS

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

#### 4.16 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *(vamp button)*

Send.

ON SCREEN

**SEND** — the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble  
**delivery status:** Delivered

PLAYS

sound: send swoosh

SOUND

send whoosh

---

**4.17** SL · JAMIE · Facebook — *Final chorus*

He leaves Messages and posts the news.

ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST — Jamie Wellerstein (now):** "some news 🤖"

**media:** SCREENSHOT — the acceptance letter

**reactions:** 👍 240

PLAYS

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

PHONES SL = Facebook · stamp "OCTOBER 2021" · clock 2:14

---

**4.18** SL · JAMIE · Facebook — *Ride the outro to the cutoff*

61 → 240.

ON SCREEN

**LIKE COUNTER SPINS** → 240

## 5 · I'm a Part of That CATHY SINGS · 13 FIRES

HER NAME, CROPPED. His life at full brightness, hers at the edge of the frame. The ghost register — typed, read by the house, never sent — does its quietest work here.

### 5.1 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — *Intro figure*

Her phone, March 2025.

ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → "MARCH 2025"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:20 · Sunday, March 9, 2025

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY's screen

PHONES SR = Lock screen · stamp "MARCH 2025" · clock 11:20

### 5.2 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *He looks at me and sees me*

She opens Facebook herself — and finds the party album. She is "and guest."

ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST** — **Random House Events (now)**: "Publication party! Tagged: Jamie Wellerstein and guest"

**media**: M7 — cast photo: party, Cathy at the frame's edge

**reactions**: 👍 180

PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SR = Facebook · stamp "MARCH 2025" · clock 11:20

### 5.3 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *And soon he wanders off*

A fan account reposts it — cropped without her.

ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST** — **bookish\_nyc (now)**: "the man of the hour ✨"

**media**: M7b — SAME PHOTO, RE-CROPPED — Cathy gone

**reactions**: 👍 322

PLAYS

sound: soft pop

### 5.4 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *And I'm a part of that.*

She comments on it anyway. Lovingly.

ON SCREEN

**COMMENT APPEARS** — Cathy: "❤️ so proud of this one"

### 5.5 SR · CATHY · Messages — *He's got a mind like a diamond*

She opens his thread — yesterday's ordinary warmth still sitting above, which makes today's NOT DELIVERED colder.

ON SCREEN

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

— Tuesday · 8:12 AM

**RECEIVED (gray)**: "gym then pages. love you"

**SENT (blue)**: "bring back oat milk"

**RECEIVED (gray)**: "👍"

— Thursday · 6:30 PM

**SENT (blue)**: "callback went ok I think?? they laughed at the right spot"

**RECEIVED (gray)**: "of course they did"

— Yesterday · 7:20 PM

**RECEIVED (gray)**: "don't wait up. this chapter is winning"

**SENT (blue)**: "leftovers in the fridge. go get it, killer"

— Today · 12:04 PM

**SENT (blue):** "lunch?"

**status:** Not Delivered

**PLAYS**

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

**PHONES** SR = Messages · stamp "MARCH 2025" · clock 11:20

**5.6** SR · CATHY · Messages — *He's got a smile that would blind me,*

1:37. She tries again. Nothing.

**ON SCREEN**

**LOCK CLOCK** — 1:37

**thread caption:** · 1:37 PM

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** "ok eating without you"

**PLAYS**

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

**5.7** SR · CATHY · Messages — *(phrase button)*

Sent into the void. Not Delivered.

**ON SCREEN**

**SEND** — the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

**delivery status:** Not Delivered

**PLAYS**

sound: send swoosh

**SOUND**

send whoosh

**5.8** SR · CATHY · Messages — *And I'm a part of that.*

3:15. Six hours of Do Not Disturb, from her side of it.

**ON SCREEN**

**LOCK CLOCK** — 3:15

**thread caption:** · 3:15 PM

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** "we're out of coffee fyi"

**SEND** — the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

**delivery status:** Not Delivered

**PLAYS**

sound: key clicks

sound: send swoosh

**SOUND**

send whoosh

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

**5.9** SR · CATHY · Messages — *And he smiles.*

THE RELEASE — everything flips to Delivered at once. He woke up. (Clock: 6:04 PM.)

**ON SCREEN**

**LOCK CLOCK** — 6:04

**STATUS FLIPS** → Delivered ✓

**HOLD** · *The tightest band sync in the song. Land it on the smile.*

**5.10** SR · CATHY · Facebook — *SHE opens the book and closes it.*

Back to Facebook — a reader has photographed the dedication page.

**ON SCREEN**

**SOCIAL POST — a reader (now):** "That dedication page though 🤔"

**media:** M12 — the dedication page · **TEXT** = DIRECTOR'S CHOICE

**reactions:** 👍 41

**PLAYS**

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

**PHONES** SR = Facebook · stamp "MARCH 2025" · clock 6:04



**5.11** SR · CATHY · Facebook — *(two bars later)*

Likes climb.

ON SCREEN

**LIKE COUNTER SPINS** → 41

**5.12** SR · CATHY · Search — *And I'm a part of that.*

In the clear — she leaves Facebook, opens Safari, and types it into Google. The loneliest cue in the show.

ON SCREEN

**SEARCH BAR – types live:** “is it normal to feel invisible at your husband’s party”

PLAYS

OPENS Safari — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = Search · stamp “MARCH 2025” · clock 6:04

**5.13** SR · CATHY · Search — *As the song ends*

She clears it.

ON SCREEN

**search BACKSPACED c**lear

## 6 · The Schmuel Song JAMIE SINGS · 9 FIRES

THE KINDEST SCREENS OF THE NIGHT. Deliberately so; the generosity buys the betrayal its full price later. Not one Elise pixel anywhere in this song.

### 6.1 SL · JAMIE · Mail — *Christmas. JAMIE has a gift for her.*

His MacBook, December 2022 — their second Christmas. Mail opens on a real inbox; the order confirmation is dated a month early. He planned this.

#### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “DECEMBER 2022”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 9:40 · Saturday, December 24, 2022

**INBOX** — loads whole, the instant the app opens:

- Herald Sq. Jewelers • — Your order has shipped 📦 — Order #4417 · arriving Dec 18 (Dec 16)
- Herald Sq. Jewelers — Order confirmed — #4417 — 1× ladies’ watch · gift wrap: yes (Nov 20)
- Elise R. — Random House — Ch. 9 notes — attached — happy holidays, J (Thursday)
- Linda Whitfield — Foreign rights — good news — Call me after the holiday. (Wednesday)
- Columbia Alumni — December newsletter — Class notes, events, and... (Monday)
- Zabar’s — Holiday hours — Open until 6 PM Christmas Eve (Monday)

#### PLAYS

the MacBook shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

cut to Mail (instant)

no animation — a real inbox does not populate; it is simply THERE, continuing past the bottom edge

**PHONES** SL = Mail · stamp “DECEMBER 2022” · clock 9:40

### 6.2 SL · JAMIE · Mail — reading — *Schmuel, you’ve got to make the dress!*

He opens the order. THE ENGRAVING — the title of the Year-5 fight, on the Year-2 gift.

#### ON SCREEN

**THE EMAIL, OPENED** — Herald Sq. Jewelers → Jamie Wellerstein · “Order confirmed — #4417” · Nov 20

Thank you for your order.

1× ladies’ watch — gift wrap: yes

Engraving (reverse): “—J, who believes you”

Estimated delivery: Thursday, December 18.

#### PLAYS

HESITATION — the pulsing touch-dot hovers over “Herald Sq. Jewelers” ... and does not commit. Holds until the next cue.

the dot presses through — the email pushes in over the inbox

**PHONES** SL = Mail — reading · stamp “DECEMBER 2022” · clock 9:40

**HOLD** · *Read it out loud in the room once. It should land like a knife later.*

### 6.3 SL · JAMIE · Pages — *The clock began to sing:*

He is writing her the story right now — real sentences, his prose.

#### ON SCREEN

**a greeked line types itself** — key clicks, text illegible by design

**a greeked line types itself** — key clicks, text illegible by design

#### PLAYS

sound: key-click burst (self-timed)

**PHONES** SL = Pages · stamp “DECEMBER 2022” · clock 9:40

### 6.4 SL · JAMIE · Pages — *“Schmuel, you’re a tailor!”*

The page fills.

#### ON SCREEN

**a greeked line types itself** — key clicks, text illegible by design

**a greeked line types itself** — key clicks, text illegible by design

#### PLAYS

sound: key-click burst (self-timed)

**6.5** SL · JAMIE · Pages — *And time is what you need!*

More.

ON SCREEN

**a greeked line types itself** — key clicks, text illegible by design

**a greeked line types itself** — key clicks, text illegible by design

PLAYS

sound: key-click burst (self-timed)

**6.6** SL · JAMIE · Pages — *And Schmuel took his needle,*

The page is nearly full — and the dedication line goes down last.

ON SCREEN

**a greeked line types itself** — key clicks, text illegible by design

**a greeked line types itself** — key clicks, text illegible by design

PLAYS

sound: key-click burst (self-timed)

**6.7** SL · JAMIE · settings2 — *And the moral of the story is:*

He builds her an audition calendar — the real Edit Calendar screen — and shares it with her.

ON SCREEN

**SETTINGS** — Calendars › Edit Calendar

· Name — CATHY — AUDITIONS 🍷

· Cathy Hiatt — Can edit

· Event Alerts — ON

PLAYS

cut to settings2 (instant)

PHONES SL = settings2 · stamp "DECEMBER 2022" · clock 9:40

**6.8** SL · JAMIE · backstage — *You have to move on.*

The profile he built her, live on the real site — her headshot, her voice, credits entered a shade more generously than she would dare.

PLAYS

cut to backstage (instant)

PHONES SL = backstage · stamp "DECEMBER 2022" · clock 9:40

**6.9** SL · JAMIE · reminders — *(final phrase)*

Reminders. A daily one, set by him: ask about her auditions.

ON SCREEN

**REMINDERS** — list "Us 🍷"

◦ ASK ABOUT HER AUDITIONS — Repeats daily · 6:00 PM

◦ pick up wrapping paper — Today

◦ finish her story — Today · Schmuel

PLAYS

cut to reminders (instant)

PHONES SL = reminders · stamp "DECEMBER 2022" · clock 9:40

**HOLD** · *Last screen of the song. Nothing else on it.*

## 7 · A Summer in Ohio CATHY SINGS · 15 FIRES

THE LETTER, ALIVE. Ohio assembles itself as she sings — attachments as punchlines, crossed clocks as a joke that will curdle into a diagnosis two songs from now.

### 7.1 SR · CATHY · Messages — *Vamp in*

Her phone, June 2024, Ohio. Three weeks married, eight hundred miles away — and three years of thread above tonight.

#### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → "JUNE 2024 · OHIO · THREE WEEKS MARRIED"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:04 · Tuesday, June 11, 2024

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

— May 24 · 8:05 AM

**RECEIVED (gray)**: "drive safe. call me from the road?"

**SENT (blue)**: "stop 1: ohio is already 60% corn"

**SENT (blue)** — **PHOTO BUBBLE**: M22 — corn. so much corn.

**RECEIVED (gray)**: "ha. miss you already"

— Sunday · 10:40 PM

**RECEIVED (gray)**: "apartment's too quiet. even the radiator misses you"

#### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY's screen

cut to Messages (instant)

**PHONES** SR = Messages · stamp "JUNE 2024 · OHIO · THREE WEEKS MARRIED" · clock 11:04

### 7.2 SR · CATHY · Messages — *I could stay here,*

She writes him the letter as a text.

#### ON SCREEN

**thread caption**: Today · 11:04 PM

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed)**: "dispatches from the middle of nowhere:"

#### PLAYS

sound: key clicks

#### SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

### 7.3 SR · CATHY · Messages — *Or I could go —*

Send. First attachment — HER photo of the snake, a real image bubble from her side.

#### ON SCREEN

**SEND** — the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

#### PLAYS

sound: send swoosh

#### SOUND

send whoosh

### 7.4 SR · CATHY · Messages — *And in a hundred years,*

Tonight's program, photographed by her: FIDDLER matinee, PORGY evening, featuring Karl.

### 7.5 SR · CATHY · Messages — *(next joke)*

Karl warming up — her twelve-second video. The sound of nightmares.

### 7.6 SR · CATHY · Phone — *And I'm so glad I could fail you in Ohio.*

She tries to FaceTime him. Unavailable.

#### ON SCREEN

**CALL SCREEN** — Jamie ❤️ · FaceTime · unavailable · outgoing

#### SOUND

outgoing ring

**PHONES** SR = Phone · stamp "JUNE 2024 · OHIO · THREE WEEKS MARRIED" · clock 11:04

**7.7** SR · CATHY · FaceTime — *INSTRUMENTAL BREAK — the call connects*

FOUR MINUTES OF FACETIME. Pre-recorded cast loops or a live feed from the wings — director's choice.

ON SCREEN

**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:09

**FACETIME** — Jamie ❤️ · FaceTime · connecting...

**main feed:** ⌚ CONNECTING

**PiP self-view:** V3 — CATHY PiP: greenroom, costume half-on

SOUND

FaceTime trill, then connect pop

PHONES SR = FaceTime · stamp "JUNE 2024 · OHIO · THREE WEEKS MARRIED" · clock 11:09

**HOLD** · *The only time all night they actually reach each other.*

**7.8** SR · CATHY · FaceTime — *Two bars in*

He appears — desk, terrible lighting, mid-laugh.

ON SCREEN

**FaceTime state** → FaceTime · 0:07

**main feed swaps** → V2 — CAST VIDEO: Jamie at his desk, waving, mid-laugh

**7.9** SR · CATHY · FaceTime — *Four bars in*

She flips the camera — a slow pan of the tiny Ohio theater.

ON SCREEN

**main feed swaps** → V4 — FLIPPED CAMERA: slow pan of the tiny Ohio theater

**7.10** SR · CATHY · FaceTime — *Break button*

Connection lost at 4:12.

ON SCREEN

**FaceTime state** → connection lost · 4:12

**7.11** SR · CATHY · ftrecents — *(she resumes singing)*

The FaceTime log — tonight's four minutes, and the week of missed calls around it.

ON SCREEN

**FACETIME RECENTS:**

- Jamie ❤️ — FaceTime Video · 4 min 12 sec · 11:13 PM
- Jamie ❤️ — FaceTime Video — Missed · 11:04 PM (red)
- Jamie ❤️ — FaceTime Video — Missed · Yesterday (red)
- Jamie ❤️ — FaceTime Video — Missed · Tuesday (red)
- Mom — FaceTime Video · 22 min · Sunday

PLAYS

cut to ftrecents (instant)

PHONES SR = ftrecents · stamp "JUNE 2024 · OHIO · THREE WEEKS MARRIED" · clock 11:09

**HOLD** · *The beat that actually hurts.*

**7.12** SR · CATHY · Facebook — *And I'm so glad I could fail you in Ohio.*

She opens Facebook — the bookstore selfie, their last uncomplicated public exchange.

ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST** — Cathy Hiatt-Wellerstein (now): "look what I found in Kentucky 🤔 SO proud"

**media:** M5 — cast photo: bookstore shelf selfie

**reactions:** 👍 68

PLAYS

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

PHONES SR = Facebook · stamp "JUNE 2024 · OHIO · THREE WEEKS MARRIED" · clock 11:09

**7.13** SR · CATHY · Facebook — *(phrase button)*

He comments. It is a good one.

ON SCREEN

**LIKE COUNTER SPINS** → 68

**COMMENT APPEARS** — Jamie: “married a one-woman street team 🤪❤️”

---

### 7.13b SR · CATHY · Mail — *(before the sign-off)*

Her FLAGGED mailbox — two emails, both the job. The callback that put her here, kept where a person actually keeps it.

#### ON SCREEN

**FLAGGED** — loads whole, the instant the app opens:

- ▶ Summer Season (Ohio) — Season contract — countersigned ✓ — Welcome to the company, Ms. Hiatt-Wellerstein. (Apr 9)
- ▶ Summer Season (Ohio) — CALLBACK — Summer Season — We loved your final audition and are thrilled to... (Apr 2)

#### PLAYS

OPENS Mail — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

no animation — a real inbox does not populate; it is simply THERE, continuing past the bottom edge

**PHONES** SR = Mail · stamp “JUNE 2024 · OHIO · THREE WEEKS MARRIED” · clock 11:09

---

### 7.14 SR · CATHY · Messages — *THE FINAL SIGN-OFF*

She signs the letter live, in the thread — still not over signing it like that.

#### ON SCREEN

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “love, MRS. JAMIE WELLERSTEIN ✨”

**SEND** — the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

#### PLAYS

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

sound: key clicks

sound: send swoosh

#### SOUND

send whoosh

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

**PHONES** SR = Messages · stamp “JUNE 2024 · OHIO · THREE WEEKS MARRIED” · clock 11:09

## 8 · The Next Ten Minutes BOTH SING · 8 FIRES

ABSENCE FIRST. True black for the boat and the vows — the only unmediated minutes of the night. Dark screens mean truth; the flood of tagged joy comes after.

### 8.1 BOTH · CATHY — *The rowboat. JAMIE proposes.*

TRUE BLACK. No screens at all. The only unmediated minutes of the night.

ON SCREEN

**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

**HOLD** · *Dark screens mean truth. Hold through the proposal.*

### 8.2 BOTH · CATHY — *AT THE VOWS — the underscore turns*

One stamp, centered, enormous. The only date both timelines will ever share.

ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → "MAY 18, 2024 · THE WEDDING"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 6:47 · Saturday, May 18, 2024

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY's screen

### 8.3 BOTH · CATHY — *CATHY: Will you share your life with me*

HER SCREEN — she opens Facebook and posts it: the engagement, three cast photos.

ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST** — **Cathy Hiatt (now): "WE'RE ENGAGED 🍷"**

**media:** M3 — cast photos: the ring / she said yes / Central Park

**reactions:** 🍷 212

PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

SOUND

unlock swish

### 8.4 BOTH · JAMIE — *JAMIE: I am not always on time*

FLIP TO HIS SCREEN — he opens Facebook and posts the identical portrait.

ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST** — **Jamie Wellerstein (now): "5.20 · forever"**

**media:** M4 — the wedding portrait (SAME photo, both accounts)

**reactions:** 🍷 340

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE's screen

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

SOUND

unlock swish

### 8.5 BOTH · CATHY — *BOTH: For the next ten minutes,*

BACK TO HER — the flood begins. Tagged in 34 photos.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION** — **Facebook (now): "Rob Tepper tagged you in 34 photos"**

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY's screen

cut to Lock screen (instant)

sound: receive ding

**SOUND**

notification tri-tone (soft)

**8.6 BOTH · CATHY** — *We can handle that.*

Mom, crying again.

**ON SCREEN****NOTIFICATION — Messages · Mom ❤️ (2m):** “crying again. so happy. call me tmrw”**PLAYS**

sound: receive ding

**SOUND**

notification tri-tone (soft)

**8.7 BOTH · CATHY** — *(final phrase of the duet)*

Rob’s toast video.

**ON SCREEN****NOTIFICATION — Messages · Rob (25m):** “sent a video — “THE TOAST” 🥂”**PLAYS**

sound: receive ding

**SOUND**

notification tri-tone (soft)

**8.8 BOTH · JAMIE** — *IN THE PLAYOFF — where the finale melody surfaces*

[CHOICE — ALONZO] DUET FLIP — his lock screen. One unread message. Sender hidden. Include, or keep the wedding pure.

**ON SCREEN****LOCK CLOCK — 11:58****NOTIFICATION — Messages (now):** “1 new message”**PLAYS**

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

cut to Lock screen (instant)

sound: receive ding

**SOUND**

notification tri-tone (soft)

**HOLD ·** *Decide in tech, not on paper.*



## 9 · A Miracle Would Happen JAMIE SINGS · 19 FIRES

THE MONTAGE. His married year rolls forward and the ghost register stops being funny. Her interpolation lands the miracle he sleeps through.

### 9.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — Vamp

His phone, October 2024. Married, at a party, alone with a screen.

ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → "OCTOBER 2024"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:52 · Friday, October 18, 2024

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE's screen

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp "OCTOBER 2024" · clock 11:52

### 9.2 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *There are people, and one of them is me,*

A reader's DM arrives.

ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION** — Instagram (now): "@a.reader.somewhere wants to send you a message"

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

### 9.3 SL · JAMIE · igreq — *Who's not allowed to look.*

He taps the request. Accept and Delete, side by side. He hovers Delete — and leaves it. Unanswered is not deleted.

ON SCREEN

**INSTAGRAM** — message request from @a.reader.somewhere (212 followers · 3 mutuals)

**request bubble:** "saw you read tonight. the swimming chapter destroyed me. drink sometime?"

**buttons:** [Delete] · [Accept] — side by side

**TOUCH-DOT** lands on [Delete] — hovering, pulsing, not pressing

PLAYS

TAP THE NOTIFICATION — the touch-dot lands on the banner, presses, Face ID passes, and the app opens DIRECTLY onto igreq. One motion. No home screen.

SOUND

tap thock

PHONES SL = igreq · stamp "OCTOBER 2024" · clock 11:52

**HOLD** · *The entire song is in that distinction.*

### 9.4 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *I'm not okay!*

He opens it and types something charming.

ON SCREEN

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

— Today · 11:52 PM

**RECEIVED (gray):** "drink sometime?"

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** "ha — careful, I take flattery very seriously"

PLAYS

cut to Messages (instant)

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp "OCTOBER 2024" · clock 11:52

### 9.5 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *(cycle 1 button)*

Deletes it.

ON SCREEN

**BACKSPACES** the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

**caption:** DRAFT · DELETED

**PLAYS**

sound: backspace rattle

**SOUND**

rapid delete clicks

**9.6** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *A miracle would happen*

Bolder.

**ON SCREEN**

**TYPES LIVE** (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “what are you doing right now”

**PLAYS**

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

**9.7** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *(cycle 2 button)*

Deletes that too.

**ON SCREEN**

**BACKSPACES** the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

caption: DRAFT · DELETED

**PLAYS**

sound: backspace rattle

**SOUND**

rapid delete clicks

**9.8** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *And I would be happy —*

The bland, safe, performative version.

**ON SCREEN**

**TYPES LIVE** (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “Thanks so much for coming! Means a lot.”

**PLAYS**

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

**9.9** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *(on the refrain’s last word)*

SEND. Politeness as camouflage.

**ON SCREEN**

**SEND** — the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

delivery status: Delivered

**PLAYS**

sound: send swoosh

**SOUND**

send whoosh

**9.10** SL · JAMIE · contact — *I could be happy —*

Her contact card. He flips Silence Notifications ON — for his wife specifically.

**ON SCREEN**

**CONTACT CARD** — Cathy 🧡 · wife · mobile

toggle: Silence Notifications — ON

**PLAYS**

cut to contact (instant)

**PHONES** SL = contact · stamp “OCTOBER 2024” · clock 11:52

**9.11** SL · JAMIE · settings2 — *(next phrase)*

THE 10 PM RULE FROM MOVING TOO FAST, PIERCED — he opens Settings himself: the same real Focus screen, now with one allowed person: R.H. EDITS.

**ON SCREEN**

**SETTINGS** — Focus > Do Not Disturb

· People — 1 allowed (R.H. EDITS)

· 10:00 PM — 6:00 AM — ON (Repeats daily · created together)

## PLAYS

OPENS Settings — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = settings2 · stamp "OCTOBER 2024" · clock 11:52

**HOLD** · *Same screen the audience watched them build together. Let them find it.*

### 9.12 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — (verse button)

Her call goes silently to voicemail. Unplayed. The finale plays it.

## ON SCREEN

**LOCK CLOCK** — 12:40

**NOTIFICATION** — Phone · Cathy 🍷 (now): "Voicemail (0:47) — unplayed"

## PLAYS

cut to Lock screen (instant)

sound: receive ding

## SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp "OCTOBER 2024" · clock 12:40

### 9.13 SL · JAMIE · Ember — CHOICE BLOCK — bridge top

[CHOICE — ALONZO] Tinder. Cut 9.13–9.16 cleanly for a subtler Jamie.

## ON SCREEN

**CARD STACK:**

- Mia, 27 — 2 miles away
- Sam, 29 — 1 mile away
- Alexa, 26 — 4 miles away

## PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Tinder — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

## SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SL = Ember · stamp "OCTOBER 2024" · clock 12:40

### 9.14 SL · JAMIE · Ember — (next hit)

Swipe right.

## ON SCREEN

**SWIPE RIGHT** — LIKE stamp, the card flies off

## PLAYS

sound: whoosh

### 9.15 SL · JAMIE · Ember — (next hit)

Swipe right again.

## ON SCREEN

**SWIPE RIGHT** — LIKE stamp, the card flies off

## PLAYS

sound: whoosh

### 9.16 SL · JAMIE · Home screen — (bridge button)

IT'S A MATCH — the real screen, Send a Message and Keep Swiping. He taps neither. Then the delete-app dialog, and his thumb over Delete App... he presses Cancel.

## ON SCREEN

**IT'S A MATCH** — full-screen overlay: You and Mia have liked each other

buttons: [Send a Message] · [Keep Swiping]

**ACTION SHEET** slides up over the app — "Remove "Tinder"? Deleting this app will also delete its data."

buttons: [Delete App] (red) · [Cancel]

**TOUCH-DOT** lands on [Delete App] — hovering, pulsing, not pressing

**PRESSES** [Cancel]

## PLAYS

cut to Home screen (instant)

**SOUND**

match chime (Ember)

**PHONES** SL = Home screen · stamp "OCTOBER 2024" · clock 12:40

**HOLD** · *No line in the show says more with less. He cannot even delete the app.*

**9.21** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *FINAL VERSE*

Back to HIS phone, February 2025, 1:14 AM. The thread is not new — the May notes exchange sits above, exactly as Nobody Needs to Know will find it.

**ON SCREEN**

**STAMP** → "FEBRUARY 2025"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 1:14 · Tuesday, February 11, 2025

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

— May 2024 ·

**RECEIVED (gray)**: "ch. 7 notes attached — coffee thursday?"

**RECEIVED (gray)** — **PHOTO BUBBLE**: ch7-notes-v2.pdf · 214 KB

**SENT (blue)**: "thursday works"

— Today · 1:14 AM

**RECEIVED (gray)**: "still up? this chapter is killing me 😊"

**PLAYS**

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE's screen

**OPENS** Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

**PHONES** SL = Messages · stamp "FEBRUARY 2025" · clock 1:14

**9.22** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *(his last sung phrase)*

SEED FOUR — the first line HE crosses. Typed live.

**ON SCREEN**

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed)**: "for you I'm always up"

**PLAYS**

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

**9.23** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *With the final chord*

Send.

**ON SCREEN**

**SEND** — the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

**delivery status**: Delivered

**PLAYS**

sound: send swoosh

**SOUND**

send whoosh

# 10 • Climbing Uphill

CATHY SINGS · 13 FIRES

HER INTERIOR VS. HIS SCROLL. The bell-tone fragments rhyme with the sung monologue and never transcribe it — protect that rule in every edit.

## 10.1 SR · CATHY · Mail — reading — Intro

Her phone, February 2024, 6:02 AM. Audition day starts in Mail — the breakdown, opened and read.

### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “FEBRUARY 2024”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 6:02 · Monday, February 5, 2024

**INBOX** — loads whole, the instant the app opens:

• Casting Networks • — BREAKDOWN — new musical (Equity) — F, 20s. Legit soprano to high C... (5:12 AM)

• Casting Office — Thank you for auditioning — We enjoyed meeting you. At this time... (Thursday)

• Backstage — 9 new roles match your profile — Apply today (Wednesday)

• Mom — Fwd: saw this and thought of you (Tuesday)

• Chase — Your statement is ready (Monday)

**THE EMAIL, OPENED** — Casting Networks → Cathy Hiatt-Wellerstein · “BREAKDOWN — new musical (Equity)” · 5:12 AM

SEEKING: F, 20s-30s.

Legit soprano to high C. Strong dancer.

MUST READ YOUNG.

Submit headshot & résumé. Sign-in opens 6:30 AM.

### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

cut to Mail (instant)

no animation — a real inbox does not populate; it is simply THERE, continuing past the bottom edge

HESITATION — the pulsing touch-dot hovers over “Casting Networks” ... and does not commit. Holds until the next cue.

the dot presses through — the email pushes in over the inbox

**PHONES** SR = Mail — reading · stamp “FEBRUARY 2024” · clock 6:02

## 10.2 SR · CATHY · Mail — reading — I’m climbing uphill,

The check-in text lands over the breakdown: she is number two hundred.

### ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION — Messages · Audition Check-In (now):** “You’re checked in: #200 of 200.

Estimated wait: 3 hr 40 min.”

### PLAYS

sound: receive ding

### SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

## 10.3 SR · CATHY · Mail — reading — (phrase button)

The bank tells her what the headshots cost. Another banner, worse.

### ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION — Chase (now):** “Declined: \$175.00 — REPRO-HEADSHOTS NYC. Available balance: \$23.41.”

### PLAYS

sound: receive ding

### SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

## 10.4 SR · CATHY · Search — FIRST BELL TONE

Her head, typed into Google and never searched. Never a caption of what she sings.

### ON SCREEN

**SEARCH BAR — types live:** “smile. breathe. don’t look at your shoes.”

### PLAYS

OPENS Safari — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

**PHONES** SR = Search · stamp “FEBRUARY 2024” · clock 6:02

**HOLD** · *Bells are the tightest MD sync in the show. One fragment per bell.*

**10.5** SR · CATHY · Search — *Second bell*

“196 to go.”

ON SCREEN

**SEARCH BAR** — types live: “196 to go”

**10.6** SR · CATHY · Search — *Third bell*

“quiet till 6, he’s writing.”

ON SCREEN

**SEARCH BAR** — types live: “quiet till 6, he’s writing”

**10.7** SR · CATHY · Search — *Fourth bell*

“he didn’t ask about the callback.”

ON SCREEN

**SEARCH BAR** — types live: “he didn’t ask about the callback”

**10.8** SR · CATHY · Search — *Fifth bell*

“what am I doing here.”

ON SCREEN

**SEARCH BAR** — types live: “what am I doing here”

**10.9** SR · CATHY · Facebook — *(his interruption section)*

She closes Safari and scrolls HIS press instead. The review, going viral.

ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST** — **BOOKS Weekly (now)**: “THE WELLERSTEIN MOMENT — the year’s most talked-about debut”

**reactions:** 👍 4212

PLAYS

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap  
sound: soft pop

PHONES SR = Facebook · stamp “FEBRUARY 2024” · clock 6:02

**10.10** SR · CATHY · Facebook — *(with the build)*

4,212 and climbing, while she waits in a hallway.

ON SCREEN

**LIKE COUNTER SPINS** → 4212

**10.11** SR · CATHY · Facebook — *(call section)*

SEED FIVE — the party photo. A figure half in frame, never named.

ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST** — **Random House · tagged (now)**: “celebrating the review!!”

**media:** M8 — cast photo: bar celebration · a figure half in frame

**reactions:** 👍 64

PLAYS

sound: soft pop

**10.12** SR · CATHY · Search — *AFTER THE LAST BELL — in the clear*

Back to Safari. Her search bar.

ON SCREEN

**SEARCH BAR** — types live: “how to quit acting gracefully”

PLAYS

OPENS Safari — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = Search · stamp “FEBRUARY 2024” · clock 6:02

**10.13** SR · CATHY · Search — *As the final vamp dies*

Cleared.

ON SCREEN

search BACKSPACED clear

# 11 · If I Didn't Believe In You JAMIE SINGS · 10 FIRES

THE FIGHT HAS AN AUDIENCE: HIS PHONE. What the argument is actually about sits unsigned on the other side of the stage all song.

## 11.1 SL · JAMIE · calevent — *The fight is already underway.*

His phone, March 2026. The party invite on the real Calendar — his ✓ and her ✗ on the same screen.

ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → "MARCH 2026"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 7:41 · Friday, March 6, 2026

**CALENDAR EVENT** — "Publication Party — Book 2 📖" · Tonight · 7:30 PM · 1745 Broadway

**invitees:** Jamie Wellerstein ✓ · Cathy Hiatt-Wellerstein ✗

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE's screen

cut to calevent (instant)

PHONES SL = calevent · stamp "MARCH 2026" · clock 7:41

## 11.2 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *If I didn't believe in you,*

Elise texts, mid-argument — he opens the thread, and it visibly has a past.

ON SCREEN

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

— Feb 2025 · 1:14 AM

**RECEIVED (gray):** "still up? this chapter is killing me 😊"

**SENT (blue):** "for you I'm always up"

— Today · 7:41 PM

**RECEIVED (gray):** "are you coming or not?"

PLAYS

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp "MARCH 2026" · clock 7:41

## 11.3 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *We wouldn't be having this fight.*

She double-texts.

ON SCREEN

**RECEIVED BUBBLE (gray):** "people are asking where you are."

## 11.4 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *If I didn't believe in you —*

"fine." The deadliest text in the show.

ON SCREEN

**RECEIVED BUBBLE (gray):** "fine."

**HOLD** · *Phrase button, then let it sit in silence.*

## 11.5 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *I'd have left you a long time ago.*

He types a reply.

ON SCREEN

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** "leaving in 10"

PLAYS

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

## 11.6 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *[CHOICE — ALONZO] send it, or pocket it*

He does NOT send. Phone in pocket, screen locked. Two very different Jamies.

ON SCREEN

**LOCK CLOCK** — 9:12

PLAYS

cut to Lock screen (instant)

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp "MARCH 2026" · clock 9:12

**HOLD** · *Decide in tech.*



**11.7** SL · JAMIE · Facebook — *THE PEAK of the bridge*

A memory resurfaces on his own phone: his own words, three years ago.

**ON SCREEN**

**SOCIAL POST — Memories (now):** ""EVERYONE go see my brilliant wife tonight. Front row forever.""

**reactions:** 👍 131

**PLAYS**

**UNLOCK** — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

**OPENS Facebook** — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap  
sound: soft pop

**SOUND**

unlock swish

**PHONES** SL = Facebook · stamp "MARCH 2026" · clock 9:12

**HOLD** · *The word "believe" curdles in real time.*

**11.8** SL · JAMIE · Facebook — *(two bars later)*

Likes climb on the corpse of it.

**ON SCREEN**

**LIKE COUNTER SPINS** → 131

**11.9** SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *ON THE BLACKOUT*

A notification he will not see until morning: she signed the Ohio contract.

**ON SCREEN**

**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:47

**NOTIFICATION — Mail · Summer Season (Ohio) (11:47 PM):** "Contract received — C. Hiatt ✓"

**PLAYS**

cut to Lock screen (instant)

sound: receive ding

**SOUND**

notification tri-tone (soft)

**PHONES** SL = Lock screen · stamp "MARCH 2026" · clock 11:47

**HOLD** · *She made the decision while he was arguing.*

**11.10** SL · JAMIE — *Final cutoff*

Black.

**ON SCREEN**

**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it

**PLAYS**

hard black

**SOUND**

room tone out

# 12 · I Can Do Better Than That CATHY SINGS · 11 FIRES

HER GHOST REGISTER, USED FOR LOVE. Drafted courage, kept receipts, a shared playlist — the exact mirror of what his register becomes.

## 12.1 SR · CATHY · maps — *Vamp — the drive*

Her phone, November 2021. Real turn-by-turn: three hours forty to the Eastern Shore.

ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “NOVEMBER 2021”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 4:05 · Saturday, November 6, 2021

**MAPS NAVIGATION** — Merge onto NJ Tpke S · via I-95 S

**ETA card:** 3 hr 40 min → Eastern Shore, MD

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

cut to maps (instant)

PHONES SR = maps · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

## 12.2 SR · CATHY · music — *I never had a dream come true*

She switches to Music — the collaborative playlist, real screen. He has already added three songs. The finale leaves it.

ON SCREEN

**MUSIC — playlist “US 🎧” · Collaborative Playlist — Jamie & Cathy**

♪ (greeked track) — Added by Jamie ✨

♪ (greeked track) — Added by Jamie ✨

♪ (greeked track) — Added by Jamie ✨

♪ (greeked track) — Added by you

PLAYS

OPENS Music — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = music · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

## 12.3 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *Carolann Mitchell married Jeff Metzger*

She opens Facebook — Carolann’s settled life, scrolling past.

ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST — Carolann (now): “MR & MRS MITCHELL 🏰”**

**media:** M11a — hometown wedding

**reactions:** 👍 74

PLAYS

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap  
sound: soft pop

PHONES SR = Facebook · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

## 12.4 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *(next phrase)*

The baby.

ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST — Carolann (now): “he’s here 💙”**

**media:** M11b — baby announcement

**reactions:** 👍 118

PLAYS

sound: soft pop

## 12.5 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *(next phrase)*

The house, crucifix on the door.

ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST — Carolann (now): “our first HOUSE 🏠”**

**media:** M11c — first house

**reactions:** 👍 203

PLAYS

sound: soft pop

**12.6** SR · CATHY · shot — *(the ex verse)*

She opens Photos — she kept the receipt: a screenshot saved a year ago, caption and all.

**ON SCREEN**

**PHOTOS — a saved screenshot, opened:** Screenshots · Saved Nov 2020

**inside the screenshot (gray bubble):** “I think I need to focus on my career right now. You’re great. — R”

**caption:** her caption: “a heartfelt letter, apparently”

**PLAYS**

**OPENS** Photos — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

**PHONES** SR = shot · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

**12.7** SR · CATHY · Messages — *THE DRAFTS — pre-chorus*

She opens his thread — two months deep — then three weeks of drafted courage begin. Draft one, October 12.

**ON SCREEN**

**THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:**

— Oct 3 · 9:20 PM

**RECEIVED (gray):** “one month anniversary of “home safe?””

**SENT (blue):** “you kept the date??”

**RECEIVED (gray):** “I keep everything”

— Thursday · 11:02 PM

**SENT (blue):** “my radiator died again 🙄”

**RECEIVED (gray):** “MY radiator works fine. just saying”

**thread caption:** · DRAFTS · NEVER SENT

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “so my lease is up in...”

**PLAYS**

**OPENS** Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap  
sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

**PHONES** SR = Messages · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

**12.8** SR · CATHY · Messages — *(next phrase)*

Draft two, two weeks later. Braver.

**ON SCREEN**

**BACKSPACES** the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

**caption:** OCT 12 · deleted

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “how attached are you to your apartment”

**PLAYS**

sound: backspace rattle

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

rapid delete clicks

**12.9** SR · CATHY · Messages — *(last phrase before the chorus)*

Draft three. All caps. Still not sent.

**ON SCREEN**

**BACKSPACES** the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

**caption:** OCT 26 · deleted

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “MOVE IN WITH ME (too much?)”

**PLAYS**

sound: backspace rattle

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

rapid delete clicks

**HOLD** · *Her ghosts are made of courage. His are made of cowardice.*

**12.10** SR · CATHY · Messages — *Will you share your life with me*

Deleted. She puts the phone down and asks him out loud instead.

ON SCREEN

**BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)**

**caption:** NOV 2 · deleted — she asks out loud instead

PLAYS

sound: backspace rattle

SOUND

rapid delete clicks

**12.11** SR · CATHY · maps — *(final chorus)*

Back to Maps. Twelve minutes out — the nav says arriving; so does she.

ON SCREEN

**MAPS NAVIGATION** — Continue straight · MD-33 W

**ETA card:** 12 min → Eastern Shore, MD · ARRIVING (green)

PLAYS

OPENS Maps — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = maps · stamp "NOVEMBER 2021" · clock 4:05

# 13 · Nobody Needs to Know JAMIE SINGS · 14 FIRES

THE PAYOFF. The same three gestures as the first night, frozen over. Speed that read as charm now reads as practice.

## 13.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — Intro, bar 1

His phone lights the dark. June 2026, 6:12 AM. Not his bed.

ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → "JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 6:12 · Friday, June 12, 2026

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE's screen

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp "JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN" · clock 6:12

## 13.2 SL · JAMIE · Messages — Bar 2

Unlocked before the house has settled. Straight to Messages. No hesitation — that is the point.

PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap  
cut to Messages (instant)

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp "JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN" · clock 6:12

**HOLD** · *Her opening took four cues of hesitation. His takes one.*

## 13.3 SL · JAMIE · Messages — I could be in Ohio.

THE SCROLL-BACK. Five years of seeded messages, in order, uncaptioned.

ON SCREEN

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

— May 2024 ·

**RECEIVED (gray)**: "ch. 7 notes attached — coffee thursday?"

**RECEIVED (gray)** — **PHOTO BUBBLE**: ch7-notes-v2.pdf · 214 KB

— Feb 2025 · 1:14 AM ·

**RECEIVED (gray)**: "still up? this chapter is killing me 😊"

**SENT (blue)**: "for you I'm always up"

— April 2026 ·

**RECEIVED (gray)**: "this stays at the office. agreed?"

**SENT (blue)**: "agreed."

— Today · 6:04 AM

**SENT (blue)**: "I keep thinking about it"

**RECEIVED (gray)**: "don't. not over text."

**HOLD** · *Fire early and let it run. Recognition is the effect — do not explain it.*

## 13.4 SL · JAMIE · Messages — I could be twenty-two —

The real dialog, over the real thread: Delete this conversation? His thumb sits on Delete. Never presses.

ON SCREEN

**ACTION SHEET** slides up over the app — "Delete this conversation? This conversation will be deleted from all your devices."

**buttons**: [Delete] (red) · [Cancel]

**TOUCH-DOT** lands on [Delete] — hovering, pulsing, not pressing

**HOLD** · *He keeps the thread. That is the corner he asks the house for.*

## 13.5 SL · JAMIE · contact — Nobody needs to know.

Her contact card, mid-edit. ELISE · ED. struck through; R.H. EDITS typed in its place.

ON SCREEN

**CONTACT CARD** — R.H. EDITS · Random House

**name mid-edit**: "Elise · Ed." struck through → "R.H. EDITS" typed in

PHONES SL = contact · stamp "JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN" · clock 6:12

**13.6** SL · JAMIE · findmy — (next phrase)

He opens Find My. The confirmation asks if he is sure. He is. “Forever,” from Moving Too Fast, ends on a real button.

**ON SCREEN**

**FIND MY — People:** Cathy ❤️: W 73rd St · now — sharing Until: Forever

**ACTION SHEET** slides up over the app — “Stop sharing your location with Cathy?”

**buttons:** [Stop Sharing] (red) · [Cancel]

**TOUCH-DOT** lands on [Stop Sharing] — hovering, pulsing, not pressing

**PRESSES** [Stop Sharing]

**FIND MY — People:** Cathy ❤️: You stopped sharing your location

**PLAYS**

**OPENS** FindMy — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

**PHONES** SL = findmy · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 6:12

**13.7** SL · JAMIE · calevent — THE BRIDGE

He opens Calendar — her opening night, three weeks out — ✓ Accepted, by him, in a life he is dismantling.

**ON SCREEN**

**CALENDAR EVENT** — “CATHY — OPENING NIGHT 🎭” · Friday, July 3 · 8:00 PM · in 3 weeks · Medina Summer Theatre, OH

**response bar:** ✓ Accepted (green)

**PLAYS**

**OPENS** Calendar — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

**PHONES** SL = calevent · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 6:12

**HOLD** · *The only time all song the marriage speaks — and it is a calendar invite.*

**13.8** SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — (verse 3)

Back to HIM, 7:58. Her good-morning text arrives.

**ON SCREEN**

**LOCK CLOCK** — 7:58

**NOTIFICATION** — Messages · Cathy ❤️ (now): “morning! call me before rehearsal? miss your face”

**PLAYS**

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

cut to Lock screen (instant)

sound: receive ding

**SOUND**

notification tri-tone (soft)

**PHONES** SL = Lock screen · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 7:58

**13.9** SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — ON HIS SWIPE

Gone. Unread.

**ON SCREEN**

**notification SWIPED AWAY** — slides off and is gone

**13.10** SL · JAMIE · settings2 — (next phrase)

He opens Settings → Battery. 9%, Low Power Mode, and the usage table that says where the night went.

**ON SCREEN**

**SETTINGS** — Settings > Battery

**gauge:** 9% · Last charged yesterday, 11:41 PM

· Low Power Mode — ON

· Messages — 6 hr 12 min (top conversation: R.H. EDITS)

· Safari — 1 hr 03 min

**PLAYS**

**UNLOCK** — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

**OPENS** Settings — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

**SOUND**

unlock swish

PHONES SL = settings2 · stamp "JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN" · clock 7:58

**13.11** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *FINAL SECTION*

Back to Messages — a new, empty conversation. To: |

**PLAYS**

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp "JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN" · clock 7:58

**13.12** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *(his last sung phrase)*

He types "hey" to someone new.

**ON SCREEN****TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): "hey"****PLAYS**

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

**13.13** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *(as the phrase ends)*

And deletes even that.

**ON SCREEN****BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)****PLAYS**

sound: backspace rattle

**SOUND**

rapid delete clicks

**13.14** SL · JAMIE · note — *In the silence before the final chord*

Notes. A note called "we need to talk," edited eleven weeks ago, one line long. He has been carrying the ending since before the fight.

**ON SCREEN****NOTES** — "we need to talk" · Edited March 24 — 11 weeks ago

cathy —

I don't know how to start this, so I'll just say it.

**PLAYS**

OPENS Notes — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = note · stamp "JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN" · clock 7:58

**HOLD** · *The last screen of the song. Let it land alone.*

# 14 • Goodbye Until Tomorrow / I Could Never Rescue You

BOTH SING • 12 FIRES

THE GRAMMAR RESOLVES. Her firsts fill as his lasts empty — the same thread from both ends, five years apart.

## 14.1 BOTH • CATHY • Lock screen — THE DUET BEGINS — first vocal entrance

HER phone. September 2021, 11:58 PM. The night they met.

ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “SEPTEMBER 2021 • THE FIRST NIGHT”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:58 • Friday, September 3, 2021

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen • stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021 • THE FIRST NIGHT” • clock 11:58

## 14.2 BOTH • CATHY • contact — CATHY: Goodbye until tomorrow —

She saves his number on a real contact card — then edits it, and adds a sparkle.

ON SCREEN

**CONTACT CARD** — Jamie ✨ • Added just now

**name mid-edit:** “Jamie Wellerstein” struck through → “Jamie ✨” typed in

PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen • sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens • sound: tap

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES BOTH = contact • stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021 • THE FIRST NIGHT” • clock 11:58

## 14.3 BOTH • CATHY • Messages — CATHY: Goodbye until I crawl to your door —

His text is already waiting: “home safe?”

ON SCREEN

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

– Today • 11:48 PM

**RECEIVED (gray):** “home safe?”

PLAYS

cut to Messages (instant)

PHONES BOTH = Messages • stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021 • THE FIRST NIGHT” • clock 11:58

## 14.4 BOTH • CATHY • Messages — CATHY: And I’m nothing but happy —

She starts her reply. SHE IS STILL TYPING WHEN THE SHOW ENDS.

ON SCREEN

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “safe 😊 tonight was”

PLAYS

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

**HOLD** • *Do not send. This is the payoff of Shiksa Goddess, two hours ago.*

## 14.5 BOTH • JAMIE • Mail — JAMIE: I could never rescue you —

FLIP TO HIS SCREEN. June 2026, 2:40 PM. His inbox is the same three emails she will read on Friday — the sender’s side.

ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “JUNE 2026 • HIS LAST AFTERNOON”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 2:40 • Friday, June 12, 2026

**INBOX** — loads whole, the instant the app opens:

• U-MOVE • — Booking confirmed — Saturday 8:00 AM — 1 bedroom • pickup W 73rd St (2:31 PM)

• Chase — Account closed — joint checking — Confirmation of closure. Funds transferred. (1:55 PM)



· Kessler & Roth LLP — Following our call — Attached, as discussed. Please review at your convenience. (2:50 PM)

**PLAYS**

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE's screen

cut to Mail (instant)

no animation — a real inbox does not populate; it is simply THERE, continuing past the bottom edge

**PHONES** BOTH = Mail · stamp "JUNE 2026 · HIS LAST AFTERNOON" · clock 2:40

**14.6 BOTH · JAMIE · Mail — JAMIE: No, no, no —**

His SENT folder. "Some practical things," 4:12 PM, To: Cathy — the email the house read from her side in Still Hurting. THE JOINT ACCOUNT FROM MOVING TOO FAST, CLOSED.

**ON SCREEN**

**SENT — loads whole, the instant the app opens:**

· To: Cathy — Some practical things — Cathy — I didn't want to do this over the phone. I went... (4:12 PM)

· To: Kessler & Roth LLP — Re: Following our call — Understood. Go ahead. (3:05 PM)

· To: U-MOVE — Booking — Saturday — Confirmed for 8 AM. One bedroom. (2:12 PM)

**PLAYS**

no animation — a real inbox does not populate; it is simply THERE, continuing past the bottom edge

**HOLD · The audience watched this open in Act One, and read it arrive in song one.**

**14.7 BOTH · JAMIE · music — JAMIE: All I could do was love you.**

He opens Music — the playlist from 2021. Leave "US"? — this button he CAN press.

**ON SCREEN**

**MUSIC — playlist "US 🎧" · Collaborative Playlist — Jamie & Cathy**

♪ (greeked track) — Added by Cathy 🍷

♪ (greeked track) — Added by you

♪ (greeked track) — Added by Cathy 🍷

**ACTION SHEET slides up over the app — "Leave "US 🎧"? You will no longer be able to listen with Cathy."**

**buttons:** [Leave Playlist] (red) · [Cancel]

**TOUCH-DOT lands on** [Leave Playlist] — hovering, pulsing, not pressing

**PRESSES** [Leave Playlist]

**banner over the playlist:** "You left this playlist"

**PLAYS**

**OPENS Music** — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

**PHONES** BOTH = music · stamp "JUNE 2026 · HIS LAST AFTERNOON" · clock 2:40

**14.8 BOTH · JAMIE · vm — JAMIE: I could never rescue you —**

The real Voicemail screen. Cathy — April 9, 2025 — 0:47, saved two years. He presses play; the transcription reads along under his final verse.

**ON SCREEN**

**VOICEMAIL — Cathy 🍷 · April 9, 2025 · 0:47 · SAVED**

**scrubber:** playing at 0:14

**transcription:** "JAMIE. CALL ME BACK. I GOT OHIO. I GOT—"

**PLAYS**

**OPENS Phone** — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

**SOUND**

**voicemail playback:** her recorded VO, 0:47

**PHONES** BOTH = vm · stamp "JUNE 2026 · HIS LAST AFTERNOON" · clock 2:40

**HOLD · The man who empties Recently Deleted keeps her happiest 47 seconds.**

**14.9 BOTH · JAMIE · vm — (verse button)**

Delete Voicemail? His thumb crosses to Delete — and presses Cancel. He keeps this too.

**ON SCREEN**

**ACTION SHEET slides up over the app — "Delete this voicemail?"**

**buttons:** [Delete Voicemail] (red) · [Cancel]

**TOUCH-DOT lands on** [Delete Voicemail] — hovering, pulsing, not pressing

**PRESSES** [Cancel]

**VOICEMAIL** — Cathy 🧡 · April 9, 2025 · 0:47 · SAVED  
**scrubber:** stopped at 0:47  
**transcription:** "JAMIE. CALL ME BACK. I GOT OHIO. I GOT—"

**SOUND**

voicemail playback: her recorded VO, 0:47

**14.10 BOTH · JAMIE · Messages** — *JAMIE: Goodbye.*

He opens her thread — the same messages the house read at 9:41 this morning, mirrored from his side. All read. Never answered.

**ON SCREEN**

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

- Monday · 11:02 PM
- RECEIVED (gray):** "are you coming home this weekend?"
- Wednesday · 8:15 AM
- RECEIVED (gray):** "please just call me"
- Wednesday · 9:30 PM
- RECEIVED (gray):** "I still have your ring"
- Today · 9:41 AM
- RECEIVED (gray):** "I'm not sure that I can do this without you"
- · READ 9:44 AM — he never answered

**PLAYS**

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

**PHONES** BOTH = Messages · stamp "JUNE 2026 · HIS LAST AFTERNOON" · clock 2:40

**HOLD** · *The image the whole night has been building to.*

**14.11 BOTH · JAMIE** — *HE puts the key on the table and goes.*

His screen dies.

**ON SCREEN**

**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it

**PLAYS**

hard black

**SOUND**

room tone out

**14.12 BOTH · CATHY** — *CATHY: Goodbye until tomorrow. (final)*

BACK TO HER. Five years earlier, still typing. She glows on through the final chord.

**ON SCREEN**

**STAMP** → "SEPTEMBER 2021 · THE FIRST NIGHT"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:58 · Friday, September 3, 2021

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

- Today · 11:48 PM
- RECEIVED (gray):** "home safe?"
- TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** "safe 😊 tonight was"

**PLAYS**

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY's screen

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, the thumb travels to the icon, presses, the app opens · sound: tap

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

unlock swish

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

**HOLD** · *Hold it. Do not resolve it.*